

Star Trek: Legacy

Only for Star Trek buffs...

After we got a taste of *Star Trek: Bridge Commander*, *Star Trek: Legacy* comes in to take a place in the list of the few space combat games. You play the role of a starship commander controlling your ship in third person; however, you can give orders or switch to any ship in your fleet. *Star Trek* freaks will ogle over the game's main features, one of them being the original voice cast for all the five captains of *Star Trek*. That's nice and all, but the game itself turns out to be something else...

The story starts off with the search for a missing Vulcan scientist, which, of course leads to the usual bad guys you have to fight off. As the story progresses, you will find yourself exchanging bullets with Klingons, Romulans, and Borg ships. Apart from "annihilate all enemies," there's the occasional mission to tow or baby-sit friendly ships/planets to keep things interesting.

The graphics are decent for a DX9 game; you won't be complaining on this front at any point. The ships have a good amount of detail, too. However, the physics is where the game comes out wrong. The collision detection is amateurish at best; you will often see pieces of debris pass right through each other or through ships—and that's only the start of the overall quirks of the game.

Moving from materialistic things to the core of any game—raw fun—*Star Trek: Legacy* turns out

quite disappointing. It starts right when you look at the Readme; you know they messed it up the moment you look at the section titled "Control Updates," which corrects the controls printed in the manual. Just when you think the Readme fixed things, you are welcomed with no option to remap your keys. This is a pain in the behind, considering the game has a huge number of controls. Add to that the absolutely horrid controls for your ship, plus there's no way to get the camera to lock behind your ship. Trying to get used to the controls itself will take off a decent chunk of your time. You're forced to control both the camera and the ship's movement in addition to targeting and firing.

The adrenaline level in dogfights is extremely low, with most ships turning around at a snail's pace. You could place a weight on the [A] key and go take a shower while your ship makes a 180 turn. Granted, these are battleships you are controlling and not fighters, but it's a game—and we don't really need to know that battleships take an eternity to turn around. This seriously affects the fights you encounter, even the epic large battles.

Star Trek: Legacy has a lot of potential, but it looks like the devs hurried the game to make the release date.

mayur_bhatia@thinkdigit.com

Rating: 3/10
Developer: Bethesda Softworks
Publisher: Ubisoft
Distributor: E-Xpress Interactive
Contact: sales@e-xpressindia.com
Price: Rs 1,299